

031. Chapter 3 Verses 16-18

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.16

एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥ 16 ॥

evaṃ pravartitaṃ cakram
nānuvartayatiha yaḥ |
aghāyurindriyārāmo
moghaṃ pārtha sa jīvati ||

evam – thus; **pravartitam** – set in motion; **cakram** – wheel;
na – not; **anuvartayati** – follows; **iha** – in this world; **yaḥ** – who;
agha-āyuh – living in sin; **indriya-ārāmaḥ** – rejoicing in the senses;
mogham – in vain; **pārtha** – O Partha; **saḥ** – he; **jīvati** – lives.

The man who does not follow the cycle thus set revolving is a sinner rejoicing in sense-pleasures and he lives in vain.

VERSE 3.17

यस्त्वात्मरतिरेव स्यादात्मतृप्तश्च मानवः ।
आत्मन्येव च सन्तुष्टस्तस्य कार्यं न विद्यते ॥17॥

yastvātmaratireva syād
ātmatṛptaśca mānavaḥ |
ātmanyevā ca santuṣṭas
tasya kāryaṃ na vidyate ||

yaḥ – who; **tu** – but; **ātma-ratiḥ** – rejoicing in the Self; **eva** – only; **syāt** – may be;

ātma-trptaḥ – satisfied with the Self; **ca** – and; **mānavaḥ** – a man;

ātmani – in the Self; **eva** – only; **ca** – and; **santuṣṭaḥ** – contented;

tasya – his; **kāryam** – duty/work; **na** – not; **vidyate** – exists.

**But he who rejoices, who is contented, who finds happiness
in Atma only, has no work to perform.**

VERSE 3.18

नैव तस्य कृतेनार्थो नाकृतेनेह कश्चन ।
न चास्य सर्वभूतेषु कश्चिदर्थव्यपाश्रयः ॥ 18 ॥

naiva tasya kṛtenārtho
nākṛteneha kaścana |
na cāsyā sarvabhūteṣu
kaścidadarthavyapāśrayaḥ ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **eva** – certainly; **tasya** – his; **kṛtena** – by action performed; **arthah** – use/interest;
- ◆ **na** – not; **akṛtena** – by action not performed; **iha** – here; **kaścana** – any;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ca** – and; **asya** – his; **sarva-bhūteṣu** – in all beings;
- ◆ **kaścit** – any; **artha-vyapāśrayaḥ** – dependence for any object.

For him, there is in this world no interest whatsoever by work done or not done. He does not depend upon any being for any object.